

Project 1 reviews have been re-issued — three of five groups are now closed

01-ml-project — Customer Segmentation · 9 September 2026

The Monday catch-up deadline has passed. Two of the three groups that had submitted nothing have now delivered, and one of them was accepted outright. **Three of five A3 groups are closed out.**

Pull and re-read your review

```
git pull origin main
```

Then open `submissions/a3-tue-sat/<your-group-id>/01-ml-project/<your-group-id>_final-review.md`

If your outcome changed, the file says so at the top and is dated **09/09/2026 (round 2)**. The 04/09 version no longer applies.

Where each group landed

GROUP	ON 04/09	NOW	WHAT HAPPENED
a3-g01	Accepted, k write-up to correct	Accepted	Rewrote the justification honestly. Note closed.
a3-g02	Not submitted	Accepted	Delivered 05/09, complete and correct.
a3-g03	Accepted	Accepted	Closed out since 29/08.
a3-g04	Not submitted	Revise	Delivered, but the file is a <code>.py</code> saved as <code>.ipynb</code> ; two required points missing.
a3-g05	Not submitted	Not submitted	Nothing has reached the repo.

Final catch-up deadline — Sunday 13/09, end of day. This applies to **a3-g04 and a3-g05**, and it is the last extension on Project 1. After Sunday the outcome is recorded as it stands.

a3-g05 — two of the three groups that were in your position have now delivered, so I no longer think the brief or the deadline is the problem. Send me one message today, even if it is only “we are stuck on git” or “we have not started”. I will act on it this week.

Saturday 12/09 — full Session 11, with a short slot at the top

We are **still at the end of Session 10**. Saturday 05/09 closed S10 out with the discussion and the mini project, and Tuesday 08/09 was not held — so Saturday is a full **S11**, with a short Project 1 slot before it starts.

DATE	WHAT IT CARRIES	PRESENTING
Sat 12/09	Full S11 + short catch-up slot	a3-g01 (short), a3-g02
Tue 15/09	S12 + short catch-up slot	a3-g04, a3-g05 (if delivered)

Saturday's two slots, five minutes each:

- **a3-g01** — the corrected $k=4$ justification, read out. Please fix the cell's line breaks before Saturday; it currently renders as one run-on block.
- **a3-g02** — the $k=2$ versus $k=3$ argument. Their silhouette gap was one thousandth of a point and they broke the tie on business grounds.

a3-g03 — you are closed out and owe nothing, but please sit in. Three groups have now reached the same kind of trade-off and written it up three different ways, and that comparison is the most useful thing in this project.

Three things worth everyone reading

Naming the boring majority correctly is the hardest part of this project. Four groups across both cohorts had a cluster of roughly 240 ordinary customers — a couple of months since the last purchase, eight or nine purchases each — and called it “VIP”, “At-Risk” or “Dormant”. Every one was returned for it. a3-g02 called theirs “Core / Regular Customers”, which sounds like the obvious choice and was not. If your persona name would send the marketing team to spend win-back budget on 80% of the customer base, the name is wrong even when the clustering is right.

Write down the trade-off you actually made. a3-g01 rewrote their k section to say plainly that $k=4$ did not win on the metrics and that they chose it anyway, for reasons they could defend. That is harder to write than a clean answer and worth more. Describing the evidence as agreeing with you when it does not is the one thing a reviewer always catches — and it puts everything else you wrote under suspicion.

A .py file renamed to .ipynb is not a notebook. A notebook is a JSON document — renaming a script produces a file that Jupyter, Colab and GitHub all refuse to open, so nobody can read or run your work. Build it in Colab or Jupyter and use **File** → **Download .ipynb**. Same rule as always: Restart & Run All, then commit *with* the outputs, then open the file on GitHub and look at what is actually there.

On session numbers

The schedule files now key everything on **dates** rather than session numbers, because a session can span two meetings or share one with a discussion round, and the two had drifted apart. `discussion/a3-discussion-schedule.md` has a table showing what each date carries. A3 now runs ahead of A1 on session numbers — that is deliberate, five groups move faster than fifteen. Project deadlines stay shared across both cohorts.

Questions on your own review come to me directly — your mentor's stage is finished. Anything about this announcement goes in the comments so the whole cohort sees the answer once.

— Hozaiifa Moustafa